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Writing assignment 1.

In the modern world, it's hard to feel secure because our information is stored not just on paper but also online and in social media when we accept to share our information with external sources. Cybersecurity is essential, as it protects our digital information, personal data, and national security, everything we agree to share online. As we discussed in our second lecture, “What is Security,” understanding security has become crucial for me. The global population will soon hit 8 billion, highlighting the importance of privacy and security. Technology plays a big part in our daily lives, and cybersecurity helps us trust online interactions. For me, working in cybersecurity means both responsibility and opportunity. This work focuses on protecting people, businesses, and countries from cyber threats. It also aims to use technology to create safer online spaces. This field changes constantly, so it needs a proactive approach and a commitment to learning.

Cybersecurity is about honesty, vigilance, and problem-solving. It keeps important information safe by making sure only the right people can see it. It also helps to stop bad things from happening and helps to fix problems when they do, and offers need help at the needed time. It requires a mix of technical skills and ethical thinking. As someone interested in cybersecurity, I see it as a way to help improve global security while building my skills in a challenging area, where I am willing to learn and create new ways of security online. A conversation from the second and third lectures impacted me even more. From the lecture slides, as we discussed, “Cybersecurity is about psychology, not engineering.” I don’t completely agree with this because I think it includes both aspects. However, these comments changed my viewpoint, as I always thought cybersecurity was just about engineering.

Key tasks in cybersecurity include investigating security incidents, analyzing weaknesses, and improving defenses. These activities are stimulating and need creativity and adaptability. There are also many job opportunities in various industries, such as finance, healthcare, government, and defense. I am excited about roles like ethical hacking, penetration testing, digital forensics, and security architecture. Each of these positions requires different skills and ways to solve problems. Thinking like an attacker while creating strong security measures adds a strategic challenge.

Cybersecurity is a challenging job because threats are always changing. Cybercriminals create more advanced attacks, so defenders must work hard to stay ahead. This ongoing struggle can be mentally exhausting since just one weakness can lead to serious problems. Another challenge is balancing security and user convenience. Professionals often have to decide between strict security measures and making systems easy to use. Additionally, cybersecurity decisions come with legal and ethical concerns. Professionals must understand rules and regulations while ensuring compliance.

I am studying Cybersecurity Engineering at Iowa State University and minoring in Criminal Justice. This combination is building a strong foundation for my career. Critical thinking is important in cybersecurity because it involves both engineering and psychology. My knowledge of criminal justice gives me an edge in my work. I speak four languages, which helps me think creatively and openly. Growing up in another country has also given me different ideas and perspectives. My courses at Iowa State have taught me programming languages like Java and C++, which are important for scripting and automation in cybersecurity. I am good at problem-solving and analytical thinking, which are crucial skills in cybersecurity. I can break down security issues, find their root causes, and implement effective solutions. My curiosity and desire to learn help me keep up with the latest security trends and techniques. Soft skills are also important in cybersecurity. I believe my

communication skills will be useful because cybersecurity professionals need to explain security risks and recommendations clearly to technical and non-technical audiences. Whether I am working with IT teams, presenting security reports, or training employees on best practices, clear communication is essential.

One experience that made me want to work in cybersecurity was when my brother's Instagram account got hacked, and his personal information was stolen. He lost access to his account, and the hacker used it to send strange messages to his friends. Some private conversations were also exposed, which caused a lot of stress and raised privacy concerns. At that time, I was just starting to study cybersecurity and was eager to help. I assisted my brother in recovering his account by following the right steps, securing his email, and turning on two-factor authentication. While looking into the issue, I found out his account was compromised through a phishing attempt; he had clicked on a fake login page that aimed to steal his login details. This experience opened my eyes to how easily social engineering tactics can trick people into giving away sensitive information. I realized that cybersecurity is not just about technology; it also involves people and awareness. Many cyberattacks happen because of human mistakes, highlighting the need for security education and good digital habits. This incident strengthened my commitment to raise cybersecurity awareness so that even those who aren't technical can protect themselves from online threats. Seeing the personal harm

from a cyber breach inspired me to pursue a career in this field and teach others about the importance of online security.

Cybersecurity is a fast-changing field that needs a mix of technical skills, strategic thinking, and a strong sense of ethics. I have a passion for solving problems and a desire to help create a safer digital world. The challenges from cyber threats are significant, but protecting people and organizations from these threats makes the effort worthwhile. My education in cybersecurity has given me a solid understanding of topics like network security and how attacks happen. I have technical skills in programming and system analysis, which help me build strong defenses against cyber threats. My analytical skills help me assess risks and create specific solutions for vulnerabilities. A key experience that strengthened my commitment to this field was helping my brother restore his hacked Instagram account. This experience showed me the real impact of cybersecurity issues and the importance of acting quickly.Working together to secure his account gave me valuable insights into the practical side of cybersecurity and the emotional effects of such incidents on people.

As I progress in my cybersecurity career, I am ready to tackle complex security challenges and stay proactive about new threats.I want to keep learning about the latest trends in cybersecurity because ongoing education is important for making a

positive difference. My main goal is to help create a safer digital space for everyone. This way, people can enjoy technology without worrying about attacks.